

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K Q 9 8 3

♥ 2

♦ A K

♣ K Q J 8

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ K Q 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♠		
All Pass			
5♠ by North			

[show S] [BID 2!D] [BID 3!S] [BID 5!C] [BID Pass]
[show NS] SOUTH's 3♠ supporting bid is enough to convince NORTH to make a slam try.

NORTH bids Blackwood 4NT. If SOUTH shows one Ace NORTH plans to bid 6♠, but when SOUTH bids 5♣ NORTH settles for 5♠

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ J 3

♥ A Q T 8 6

♦ T 3

♣ J T 7 4

♠ A 6 4

♥ K J 9

♦ A K Q J 9

♣ K Q

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

[show S] [BID 2!C] [BID 4NT] [BID 6!H] [show NS] NORTH makes a positive 3♥ response to SOUTH's 2♣ opener. This promises at least 8 points and a 5-card suit with two or more honors.

SOUTH only needs to know one thing - how many Aces in the NORTH hand. A Blackwood 4NT tells her the answer is one, so she bids 6♥.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 9 7

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ K Q 8 6

♣ A 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K Q

♥ K 6

♦ A 4

♣ K Q J 9 7 3 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			

[show S] [BID 4!C] [BID 6NT] [show NS] When NORTH opens 1NT, point-count alone tells SOUTH that 6NT can surely be made. NORTH is bound to hold at least two Aces. But SOUTH doesn't want to miss a Grand slam.

SOUTH bids 4♣, (Gerber), and NORTH admits to just two Aces.

So SOUTH settles for the small slam.

Board 4

South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K Q 6 4 3

♥ K 5

♦ K 7 3

♣ A K

♠ J 9 5 2

♥ A J 7 4 3

♦ A Q

♣ 9 8

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 3!S] [BID 5!H] [BID Pass]
[show NS] NORTH has a powerhouse and knows she will reach a slam somewhere. When SOUTH supports the ♠s, it seems she has found her spot.

Blackwood tells her that SOUTH has two Aces. She can see there are 12 tricks available and decides to take a chance that SOUTH will have a thirteenth trick somewhere among his opening hand points.

She bids 7NT.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by North			

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K 2

♥ K Q 6 5

♦ K Q J

♣ K J 6

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ J 7 3

♥ A J T 9 8

♦ 8 3 2

♣ Q 8

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	5♥		
All Pass			
5♥ by South			

[show S] [BID 2!H] [BID 5!D] [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH is tempted to go right to 6♥ when she hears SOUTH's positive response. BUT, she should use Blackwood first.

It's good thing she did because SOUTH admits to only one Ace - they are missing two Aces.

Board 6
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 6 3

♥ K T 7

♦ A 9 4

♣ Q 9 8 7

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K Q 4

♥ A 8

♦ K Q J T 7 3

♣ K 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4 ♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			

[show S] [BID 1!D] [BID 4!C] [BID 6NT] [show NS] SOUTH not only has 20 points, he also has a lot of winners. So when NORTH jumps to 2NT, showing 13-15 points, SOUTH uses Gerber.

NORTH shows two Aces so SOUTH decides 6NT will be just right.

Board 7
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q 8 5

♥ J 6 3

♦ 8 7

♣ A Q J 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A J 9 6 3

♥ A 4

♦ A Q J 6

♣ K 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♠	Pass	5NT
Pass	6 ♣	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			

[show S] [BID 2!S] [BID 4NT] [BID 5NT] [BID 6!S] [show NS] When NORTH gives immediate ♠ support, SOUTH's thoughts naturally turn to slam. This is a good hand to use Blackwood on, so SOUTH bids 4NT. NORTH's 5♦ answer shows one Ace, which SOUTH cleverly deduces must be the ♣A. SOUTH bids 6♠ since NORTH has not bid strongly enough to think about 7.

Board 8

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ A 6 4	♠ -
♥ -	♥ Q J 9 8 7 4	♥ -
♦ -	♦ J 9 8 3	♦ -
♣ -	♣ -	♣ -

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J
♥ A K T
♦ K Q 2
♣ K Q 7 3

West	North	East	South
			2 ♣
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	3 ♥
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	6 ♣	Pass	6 ♥
All Pass			
6 ♥ by North			

[show S] [BID 2!C] [BID 3!H] [BID 4NT] [BID 6!H] [show NS] SOUTH expects to bid 2NT at his second turn, but NORTH gives a positive 2 ♥ response and his thinking changes! First he supports ♥s, setting the trump suit.

NORTH then bids 3 ♠, showing first round control. SOUTH tries 4NT (Blackwood) and NORTH replies 6 ♣. This shows a ♣ void and one Ace, obviously the ♠ A.

SOUTH bids 6 ♥, knowing they must lose the ♦ A.

Board 9

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ K 5	♠ -									
♥ -	♥ A K T 7 5 3	♥ -									
♦ -	♦ K 7	♦ -									
♣ -	♣ J 9 6	♣ -									
<table><tr><td></td><td>N</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>W</td><td></td><td>E</td></tr><tr><td></td><td>S</td><td></td></tr></table>				N		W		E		S	
	N										
W		E									
	S										
	♠ A 8 4 2										
	♥ Q J 8 6										
	♦ A 9 8 6 3										
	♣ -										

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	4 ♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5NT
Pass	7 ♥		
All Pass			
7 ♥ by North			

[show S] [BID 4!C] [BID 5NT] [BID Pass] [show NS] SOUTH's jump to 4♣ is a Splinter bid, at least 4-card ♥ support, at least opening hand, and a ♣ Singleton or Void.

NORTH bids 4NT, Blackwood.

SOUTH's 5NT reply shows two Aces and a Void somewhere, obviously ♣s.

NORTH counts thirteen tricks and bids 7♥.

Board 10

South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ -

♥ A 9 7 5

♦ K 9 8 6 4

♣ J 9 3 2

♠ K 5 3

♥ K Q J T 3

♦ A

♣ K Q T 6

N

W E

S

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4NT] [BID Pass] [show NS] SOUTH figures that if NORTH holds two Aces he will bid the slam.

NORTH only has one Ace, but she has something else just as good - a void in a suit which is higher-ranking than ♥s.

SOUTH manages to figure out that NORTH has a ♠ void and bids the slam anyway.

Board 11

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 9 8 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ 7

♣ K J 6 3

♠ K 7 5 3

♥ J 8 7

♦ A 8 6 5

♣ 7 4

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

[show S] [BID 2!S] [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH may have a good hand but SOUTH merely gave a simple raise. Even if SOUTH has a maximum there won't be a slam.

Board 12
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q 7 5 3

♥ T 9 4 2

♦ A 8

♣ K J 4

♠ -

♥ K Q J 8 6 3

♦ K J 2

♣ A Q 6 5

W

N

E

S

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♦	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by South			

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4!C] [BID 6!H] [show NS]
SOUTH has a tough decision after the two
Control-showing bids.

If he uses Blackwood and NORTH shows two Aces
he will be no better off, because he won't know if one
of the Aces is the useless ♠A. Based on knowing
that NORTH holds the ♦A, he bids 6♥, hoping that
he can at least make that and that 7 isn't a laydown!

Board 13

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ K 6 2	♠ -									
♥ -	♥ A T 9	♥ -									
♦ -	♦ A K 3	♦ -									
♣ -	♣ A K 8 4	♣ -									
	<table><tr><td></td><td>N</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>W</td><td></td><td>E</td></tr><tr><td></td><td>S</td><td></td></tr></table>		N		W		E		S		
	N										
W		E									
	S										
	♠ A 7										
	♥ K 3										
	♦ Q J 9 8 7 4 2										
	♣ 7 6										

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5NT	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by North			

[show S] [BID 4!C] [BID 5!C] [BID 7NT] [show NS] SOUTH isn't sure just how much he can make, but surely 6♦ isn't too much to hope for.

He starts with a Gerber 4♣ and NORTH shows three Aces.

Hmmm, 5♣ asks for Kings and NORTH shows three.

Hmm, SOUTH can now count all thirteen tricks, so he forgets about the ♦ slam and bids 7NT.

Board 14

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ J 8
♥ J 7 2
♦ 8 5
♣ A K Q T 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K Q
♥ K Q 6
♦ K Q 3
♣ J 8 7 5

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT		
All Pass			
4NT by South			

[show S] [BID 2NT] [BID 4!H] [BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH has 13 points and can contribute six tricks so she figures that twelve tricks will be a slam (dunk).

However, just to make sure the opponents don't take the first two tricks she checks with Gerber.

Uh Oh, missing two Aces she signs off at 4NT. She could also happily play 5♣, but it would be tricky to get there. Very tricky.

Board 15
North Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 7 5
♥ Q 9 6
♦ A 9 8 3
♣ A Q 7

N

W E

S

♠ A Q 6
♥ K 7 3
♦ K 6
♣ K T 6 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	4NT
All Pass			
4NT by North			

[show S] [BID 4NT] [show NS] Yes, this has nothing to do with Gerber or Blackwood, but everything to do with smart bidding.

SOUTH has a 16 points and NORTH has 15, 16 or 17. SOUTH wants to be in 6NT if NORTH has 17, but merely a Notrump game if she has 15 or 16.

The way to find out is to bid 4NT - not Blackwood but merely an invitation to bid 6NT. In this case, NORTH has but 15 points and declines the invitation. If her ♥Q were changed to the ♥A she would bid 6NT and collect her twelve easy tricks.

Board 16
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q J 4

♥ K 6

♦ K 4

♣ K Q J T 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A 8 7 6

♥ Q J 7

♦ A J 3

♣ A 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			

[show S] [BID 1NT] [BID 4NT] [BID Pass] [show NS] When SOUTH opens 1NT NORTH hopes his hand includes all four Aces so she can bid 7NT. So she uses Gerber to find out.

But, when she discovers they are missing an Ace she settles for 6NT.

Board 17

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A K

♥ A Q T 9 6

♦ A Q J 3

♣ A K

♠ 9 7 2

♥ K J 5 3

♦ K 7

♣ 7 6 4 2

W

N

E

S

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by North			

[show S] [BID 2!D] [BID 3!H] [BID 5!C] [BID 6!H]
[BID Pass] [show NS] NORTH has a pretty good
hand, and when SOUTH shows ♥ support she
naturally thinks about slam.

She has all four Aces but she wants to know about
Kings. Unfortunately she can't start at 5NT because
that has a different meaning, so she goes through the
4NT sequence even though she already knows the
Ace answer.

Finding SOUTH with two Kings was what she
wanted.

Board 18
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A 6 2

♥ A T 4

♦ K 7 5

♣ K 8 6 2

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K 7

♥ K 9

♦ A Q J T 4

♣ A Q J 7

[show S] [BID 1!D] [BID 4!C] [BID 5!C] [BID 7NT] [show NS] SOUTH is just shy of a 2♣ opening bid, and when NORTH shows 13-15 points SOUTH wants to be in a slam.

SOUTH cannot use Blackwood because 4NT would be a natural invitation, but with NORTH's latest bid being 2NT he can use Gerber.

Two Major Aces and two Minor Kings fill the holes in SOUTH's hand so he bids 7NT.

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♠	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by North			

Board 19

North Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ 6

♥ K 4

♦ K J 9 7 4

♣ A Q J 9 2

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A K 5

♥ 7

♦ Q T 6 5 3

♣ K T 8 4

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
All Pass			
5♦ by North			

[show S] [BID 3!D] [BID 4!S] [BID 5!D] [show NS]
NORTH thinks slam may be possible, so she uses Blackwood.

And that's what Blackwood is really good for - keeping you out of slams when you are missing two Aces!

Board 20
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K 4

♥ K Q T 9 5

♦ A 7 6

♣ A 5 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A Q J 7 3

♥ A J 8 6

♦ 5 3

♣ 8 7

[show S] [BID 1!S] [BID 3!H] [BID 5!H] [BID Pass]
[show NS] NORTH knows SOUTH has at least five ♠s, and they might provide discards for two or three of her minor suit losers.

She tries Blackwood and, sure enough, SOUTH comes through with two Aces.

Even with all the Aces NORTH knows there are not enough points for Grand, so she bids 6♥.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			
6♥ by North			

Board 21

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A 6 2
♥ K Q J 7
♦ 6
♣ K Q J T 9

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 5 3
♥ A T 9 5 2
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 4

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4NT] [BID 5NT] [BID Pass] [show NS] When NORTH answers Blackwood with one Ace SOUTH decides to bid 5NT to ask for Kings.

With two Kings, NORTH would bid 6♥. But she knows that if she does so, SOUTH might stop right there.

Knowing the 5NT bid guarantees all four Aces, NORTH figures her ♣ suit will supply five tricks so she bids 7♥.

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	5NT
Pass	7♥		
All Pass			
7♥ by South			

Board 22

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ 8 7
 ♥ Q 9 7 4
 ♦ K Q 5
 ♣ A T 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K Q 5
 ♥ A J 6 5 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ K Q J

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4NT] [BID 5!H] [show NS] SOUTH thinks there might be slam if NORTH holds both minor Aces, so he tries Blackwood.

When NORTH shows just one Ace SOUTH is afraid he will have a trump loser as well, so he stops at 5♥.

It turns out that SOUTH might make twelve tricks, depending on the ♥K situation.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♦	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by South			

Board 23

North Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ A J 6

♥ K 5

♦ A Q 6 2

♣ A 9 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 4 2

♥ A Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ K

♣ K 3

[show S] [BID 1!H] [BID 4!C] [BID 5!C] [BID 7NT] [show NS] SOUTH might be tempted to blast into Blackwood with his first bid, pushing toward some slam in ♥s. He chooses to temporize with a 1♥ response and is rewarded when NORTH jumps to 2NT (18-19 points).

The Notrump bid prevents SOUTH from using Blackwood, but Gerber 4♣ will work just fine. When he discovers that NORTH holds three Aces and one King he can count thirteen tricks.

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♣
Pass	5♥	Pass	7NT
All Pass			
7NT by North			

Board 24
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q 6 3

♥ A T 7

♦ 9 5 2

♣ A T 8 6

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A K

♥ K Q 4

♦ K Q J 3

♣ K Q J 5

[show S] [BID 2!C] [BID 4!C] [BID 6NT] [show NS] NORTH responds 2NT, showing 8+ points with no 5-card suit.

SOUTH only needs to know how many Aces are in the NORTH hand. He must use Gerber since 4NT in this situation would not be Blackwood.

When NORTH shows two Aces SOUTH bids 6NT.

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by North			